

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Document-Based Question

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Analyze the following two primary sources using the HIPPA framework (Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view) for each document. Then construct a multi-paragraph argument responding to the central question: How did civil rights leaders at the March on Washington use different rhetorical strategies to frame their demands for racial justice, and what do these differences reveal about tensions within the movement over pace and methods of change?

The sources

Document 1

Excerpt from John Lewis, Chairman of the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC), speech delivered at the March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom, Lincoln Memorial, Washington, D.C., August 28, 1963. Source: Congressional Record; archived at the Library of Congress, loc.gov.

“We march today for jobs and freedom, but we have nothing to be proud of, for hundreds and thousands of our brothers are not here. They have no money for their transportation, for they are receiving starvation wages, or no wages at all... In good conscience, we cannot support wholeheartedly the administration's civil rights bill, for it is too little and too late. There's not one thing in the bill that will protect our people from police brutality... The revolution is at hand, and we must free ourselves of the chains of political and economic slavery. The nonviolent revolution is saying, 'We will not wait for the courts to act, for we have been waiting for hundreds of years. We will not wait for the President, the Justice Department, nor Congress, but we will take matters into our own hands and create a source of power, outside of any national structure, that could and would assure us a victory.' To those who have said, 'Be patient and wait,' we must say that 'patience' is a dirty and nasty word. We cannot be patient, we do not want to be free gradually. We want our freedom, and we want it now.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 2

Excerpt from Fannie Lou Hamer's testimony before the Credentials Committee of the Democratic National Convention, Atlantic City, New Jersey, August 22, 1964. Sources: Library of Congress, Prints & Photographs Division (Warren K. Leffler photograph dated Aug. 22, 1964, <https://www.loc.gov/pictures/item/2003688126/>); Library of Congress Law Blog, *In Custodia Legis*, "Stunned by Her Thunder: Fannie Lou Hamer" (<https://blogs.loc.gov/law/2021/02/stunned-by-her-thunder-fannie-lou-hamer/>); transcript via Iowa State University Catt Center Archives of Women's Political Communication.

"I was carried to the county jail and put in the booking room. They left some of the people in the booking room and began to place us in cells... Three white men came into my room. One of the men said, 'We are going to make you wish you was dead.' They had me lay down on a bunk bed on my face, and they beat me. I screamed to God in pain... All of this is on account of we want to register, to become first-class citizens... If the Freedom Democratic Party is not seated now, I question America. Is this America, the land of the free and the home of the brave, where we have to sleep with our telephones off the hooks because our lives be threatened daily, because we want to live as decent human beings in America?"

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

Using both documents and your knowledge of the Civil Rights Movement (US.75, US.77), analyze how Lewis and Hamer employed different rhetorical approaches to advocate for racial justice. In your response: 1. Conduct a HIPP analysis of each document. 2. Compare the rhetorical strategies used by each speaker. 3. Evaluate how the different contexts (1963 March on Washington vs. 1964 DNC challenge) shaped each speaker's argument. 4. Synthesize your analysis to argue whether the movement's strength came from unity of message or diversity of approaches.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

